



2.02 Hooking & Unhooking Trailers

1. Purpose

The purpose of the Standard Operating Procedure is to identify the hazards and define the steps involved in “Hooking and Unhooking Trailers /Shacks .

2. Scope

This procedure is intended for use by the Silverpoint employees .

3. Hazard Assessment & Identification

- Slips , Trips , Falls
- Bending , Lifting , Twisting , Pushing , Pulling
- Personal Injury
- Physical Stress
- Mental Stress
- Temperature Extremes
- Potential Stored Energy
- Equipment Failure
- Ergonomics

4. EHS Requirements

- Fire Retardant Coveralls
- CSA Approved Boots
- Safety Glasses
- Gloves
- Hardhat
- Hearing Protection
- Wheel Chocks
- Correct Lifting Techniques
- PMI



5. References

- Silverpoint Corporate Codes of Practice
- Alberta OH&S
- Silverpoint Task List
- Silverpoint THA 2.02

6. Procedure

- 6.1. Before you begin to hook or unhook from the trailer/shack, you must complete your pre/post trip. This is to ensure that all the equipment that you are about to use is safe and free of damage. Refer to SOP No: 2.08
- 6.2. **Hooking up to Trailer/Shack**
 - 6.2.1. Drive into position and safely park the truck in front of the equipment you wish to tow.
- 6.3. If necessary, at this point you will install the trailer hitch to the receiver.
 - 6.3.1. Using proper lifting techniques putting the hitch onto the receiver, ensuring the hitch pins are securely in place.
 - 6.3.2. Make sure that the pintle or hitch is open.
- 6.4. Before you back up, ensure trailer wheels are chocked and that the pintle eye or ball is directly in line with hitch.
 - 6.4.1. In the case that you are hooking up to a ball and hitch, the ball must be below the hitch. You can do this by adjusting the trailer jack either up or down.
 - 6.4.2. In the case that you are hooking up with a pintle and pintle eye configuration, the pintle eye must be above the pintle hitch. You accomplish this by either dropping your air bags (if truck is so equipped) or, by raising or lowering the trailer/shack jack.
- 6.5. Before you begin to back under the pintle eye or hitch, check to see if there is a spotter /guide available to aid you in your task.
 - 6.5.1. When you begin to back up, it is desired to have your truck and trailer/shack lined up straight so that you can see down both sides of the unit.
 - 6.5.2. Begin to back up very slowly. Refer to SOP 2.01. Keep backing until your spotter /guide directs you to stop or until you feel the pintle or hitch slightly touch the pintle eye or ball.
 - 6.5.3. Get out ensuring that the truck and trailer/shack are in the correct position so that you may connect the two units together.
- 6.6. Now you are in position to connect the two units together.
 - 6.6.1. In the case that you are connecting to a ball and hitch configuration. Hook up your safety chains. With the



trailer jack, lower the trailer hitch onto the ball and close the hitch latch and lock the hitch latch into place using the pin provided . Visually check that the hitch is secured to the ball .

6.6.2 At this point you will connect the trailer power cord to the power supply receptacle on the truck and ensure brake pull away line is secure and trailer jack is all the way up and the trailer /shack lights all work .

6.6.2. In the case that you are connecting to a pintle and pintle eye configuration ,connect your tow chains and lower the pintle eye onto the pintle hitch using the trailer /shack jack, or (if so equipped) raise your air bags so that the pintle hitch connects to the pintle eye .

6.6.3. Now close the pintle onto the pintle eye and ensure that the pintle hitch is locked into position .

6.6.4. Connect your air lines, blue to blue and red to red .

6.6.5. Connect your trailer /shack power cord to the power supply receptacle on the truck and ensure that the trailer /shack jack is all the way up and all the trailer /shack lights work .

6.6.6. Before you leave with your unit in tow, **PICK UP YOUR WHEEL CHOCKS** .

6.6.7. Complete a walk-around to ensure that you are safe to proceed . For example : pick up your stairs and stair rails, sewer pipe, satellite cable and any other debris that may be laying around . Ensure that nothing is dragging , and your load is secure . Do your part to ensure the area is clean and free of garbage .

6.7. Unhooking from Trailer/Shack

6.7.1. Drive onto a safe spot as level as possible and park the unit .

6.7.2. Get out and assess the situation ensuring that the trailer /shack is parked in a safe manner . On as level as a spot as you can and can be left on that spot for the duration that you need .

6.7.3. If you are pleased with the spot, **CHOCK THE TRAILER /SHACK WHEELS** .

6.7.4. In the case that you have a hitch ball combination unlock the hitch latch and open the hitch latch . Put a block under the center of the trailer jack and begin to lower the jack until the trailer hitch is off the ball .

6.7.5. Now disconnect the power cord from the truck ensuring that nothing is remaining hooked to the truck . For example , Safety chains and brake away cable are disconnected .

6.7.6. In the case that you have a pintle and pintle eye combination , put a block under the trailer /shack jack and begin to lower the jack until it rests firmly on the center of the block .

6.7.7. Now open the pintle and jack up the trailer /shack until the pintle eye is off the pintle hitch . Or if so equipped , drop your air bags so that the pintle eye is off the pintle hitch .

6.7.8. At this point you will want to disconnect the power cord, air lines and tow chains from the unit in tow .

6.7.9. Ensure that you are completely disconnected from the trailer /shack and drive ahead a few feet and reinflate your air bags (if so equipped) .

6.7.10. If necessary , using proper lifting techniques , remove the hitch from the truck and lay it down in a safe place .



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Remember : if you are in doubt about what to do, call your Supervisor